



- ① **measure**['meʒə] *n.* 议案
 ② **bare**[beə] *a.* 勉强的
 ③ **omission**[əu'mɪʃən] *n.* 遗漏
 ④ **eliminate**[ɪ'lɪmɪneɪt] *v.* 消除, 根除
 ⑤ **embarrassing**[ɪm'bærəsɪŋ] *a.* 令人难堪的
 ⑥ **collapse**[kə'læps] *n.* (系统或制度等的) 崩溃; 瓦解

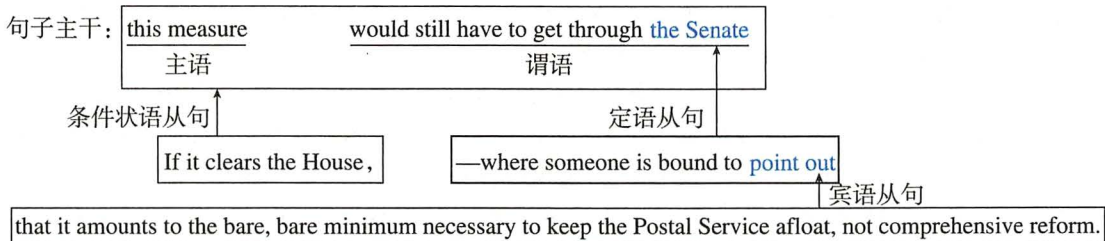
- ⑦ **transform**[træns'fɔ:m] *v.* 改造, 改革

● 经典搭配

- ① be bound to 一定, 肯定
 ② amount to (意义、效果、价值等方面) 等同, 接近
 ③ keep... afloat 使……(经济上) 维持下去
 ④ collective bargaining (工会与雇主的) 集体谈判

If it clears the House, this measure would still have to get through the Senate—where someone is bound to point out that it amounts to the bare, bare minimum necessary to keep the Postal Service afloat, not comprehensive reform.

结构切分:



功能注释: 本句主干为 this measure would still have to get through the Senate. 条件状语从句 If it clears the House 回应提案(it=this measure)目前进展“正在众议院(the House)接受审议”。破折号后内容修饰 the Senate, 以“参议院必会有人提出质疑”侧面凸显“提案缺陷明显”, 其中 that 宾语从句为 it amounts to A not B 取舍判断结构。



第四段作者发起评判, 指出法案缺陷、批驳立法者。关键词: ① bare, bare minimum; ② getting frightened.

①句概述指出该法案作用极其有限、并非全面邮政改革。If it... this measure would still have to... (it 与 this measure 同指) 以让步假设语气(假使……提案还必须……)回应上段②句 moving through the House, 说明立法进程, 并暗示提案前景未卜: 即便能在众议院获批准, 还必须经过参议院一关。注: clear 与 get through 此处均为专用表述, 两者近义: clear 意为 to give or get official permission for something to be done “被批准, 获许可”; get through 意为 if a new law gets through parliament, it is officially approved “[新法律]经由…通过”(同时有其另外一层含义 to come successfully to the end of an unpleasant experience or period of time “艰难地挣扎、熬过[一段困难时期]”)。

破折号之后推测提案在参议院必遭异议, 由此揭示法案明显缺陷、暗示作者态度“不希望提案就此通过”(注: 两院的立法规则不同, 众议院强调“多数决定”原则; 而参议院突出“一致同意”原则, 参议员个人可以阻止立法进程)。

where someone is bound to point out (be bound to 意为“很有可能, 肯定会”)以“极其肯定的推测语气”侧面说明“法案缺陷显而易见”。that 从句以取舍判断结构 it amounts to A, not B (amount to 意为“等同于, 根本就是”)直击法案缺陷——治标不治本, the bare, bare minimum necessary to... (中心词为 the minimum; keep... afloat 意为“使不欠债, 勉强维持”)以四重强调(最低值→勉强维持邮局运转的最低值→刚刚够勉强维持邮局运转的最低值→刚刚, 刚刚够勉强维持邮局运转的最低值)凸显法案仅为“勉强维持邮局运转的最低配”; comprehensive reform (全面彻底的改革)则是改变 USPS 现状、使其得以摆脱困境的正确途径, 也是当前提案未能达到的高度。